

CONNAR ELLINGTON

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Full UK Driving Licence & Vehicle | British Citizen — Right to Work in UK

SOC ANALYST PROFILE

SOC-focused analyst with a CompTIA CySA+ certification and hands-on enterprise experience triaging phishing (Mimecast, VirusTotal) and endpoint alerts (BitDefender). Extends this through self-directed home-lab detection engineering — deploying and tuning a Wazuh SIEM, running real attack and honeypot simulations, and performing static/dynamic malware analysis (dnSpy, PEStudio, ProcMon, Wireshark) — with findings mapped to MITRE ATT&CK. Clear communicator across technical and non-technical stakeholders, comfortable under pressure, with a strong ITIL-aligned incident-handling foundation.

SKILLS

Security Monitoring & Analysis: Security Alert Monitoring & Triage | SIEM Log Analysis (Splunk, Wazuh) | Phishing & Email Threat Analysis (Mimecast) | Threat Intelligence & IOC Verification (VirusTotal) | Endpoint Detection & Response (BitDefender) | Network Traffic Analysis (Wireshark) | MITRE ATT&CK Framework (practical application)

Malware Analysis & Threat Collection: Static/Dynamic Malware Analysis (dnSpy, Ghidra, PEStudio, Process Monitor, RegShot, System Informer) | IOC Extraction | Honeypot Deployment & Analysis (T-Pot: Cowrie, Suricata, Dionaea) | Attack Simulation (Hydra, Nmap)

Technical Foundations: Active Directory & Azure AD | PowerShell Scripting | Network Fundamentals (TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VPN, Firewalls) | Windows Server 2016/2019 | Linux Fundamentals | Vulnerability Remediation (Cyber Essentials Plus, ISO 27001)

Ways of Working: ITIL-Aligned Incident Management | Cross-Functional Collaboration | Clear Technical Communication | Working Under Pressure in Fast-Paced Environments

CAREER EXPERIENCE

IT Operations Engineer

Selective Travel Management | Remote | November 2025 – July 2026

- Strengthened organisational security posture by triaging phishing emails (Mimecast) and suspicious attachments (VirusTotal) and monitoring endpoint alerts (BitDefender), contributing to the identification and containment of email-based threats across a 200-user organisation.
- Maintained secure, uninterrupted business operations by administering Active Directory, Azure AD, and Microsoft 365 for approximately 200 users with zero major access-related incidents.
- Delivered consistent IT and security support at scale by resolving 60–100 tickets per week spanning standard IT issues and phishing/email-threat analysis, maintaining high resolution throughput while sustaining service quality.
- Reduced organisational risk from faulty updates by acting as a pilot tester for new software patches and deployments across a 200-user environment, validating stability before wider rollout.
- Strengthened compliance and operational resilience by leading vulnerability remediation and endpoint hardening toward Cyber Essentials Plus certification, while maintaining ISO 27001-aligned documentation and audit-readiness.
- Increased operational efficiency and restored service continuity by designing PowerShell automation for recurring admin tasks and diagnosing authentication, connectivity, and endpoint performance issues.

Global Service Desk Analyst

Venator Materials | Wynyard, Stockton-on-Tees | July 2024 – October 2025

- Delivered first- and second-line technical support at enterprise scale, supporting a global user base of 1,000+ across multiple regions and resolving 50+ tickets weekly including access issues, update failures, and endpoint faults.
- Maintained secure and compliant user access management by administering accounts, permissions, and mailboxes through Azure AD and Exchange Admin Centre for 1,000+ users.
- Improved cross-team incident resolution and stakeholder confidence by coordinating with infrastructure, network, and security teams on escalated issues, and translating complex technical problems into clear guidance for global users and senior leadership.

Customer Retentions Advisor (Technical Support)

Virgin Media | Preston Industrial Park, Stockton-on-Tees | May 2019 – July 2024

- Reduced engineer callouts and service costs by guiding customers through structured network and connectivity troubleshooting, resolving approximately 75% of issues remotely without requiring a dispatch.
- Strengthened team capability by coaching and mentoring 20+ new starters on troubleshooting procedures and customer handling.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS — HOME LAB PORTFOLIO

Self-directed home lab work building and attacking my own detection infrastructure to develop and demonstrate practical SOC and malware analysis skills beyond day-to-day service desk work. Full write-ups, real evidence, and MITRE ATT&CK mapping for each project are documented on GitHub.

SIEM Deployment & SSH Brute-Force Detection (Wazuh)

GitHub: github.com/ConnarE92/-SOC-Engineering-and-Detection

- Deployed a two-endpoint Wazuh SIEM (Windows + Linux agents) with Sysmon integration for enhanced Windows telemetry, configuring log ingestion, correlation rules, and dashboard alerting from the ground up.
- Simulated an SSH brute-force attack (Hydra) against the Linux agent and analysed the resulting Wazuh correlation alert, confirming detection via cross-referenced auth.log evidence.
- Identified and remediated a real configuration gap (root SSH login enabled) surfaced by the test and mapped the attack technique to MITRE ATT&CK T1110 (Brute Force).

Multi-Sensor Honeypot Deployment & Validation (T-Pot)

GitHub: github.com/ConnarE92/-SOC-Engineering-and-Detection/tree/main/Honeypot-Projects

- Deployed T-Pot's multi-honeypot framework (Cowrie, Dionaea, Heralding, Suricata, p0f) on an isolated Ubuntu VM, diagnosing and resolving a port-631 conflict between the OS's default CUPS service and T-Pot's ipphoney container without reinstalling the OS.
- Validated the sensor pipeline end-to-end by running a controlled attack set from Kali (full port/version scan, SSH and FTP brute-force via Hydra, SMB subnet probing), confirming accurate capture and logging across all five sensors.
- Scoped the report specifically around infrastructure deployment, diagnosis, and validation — distinct from detection-rule tuning, which is covered separately in the SIEM/Wazuh project above.

AgentTesla Malware Analysis — Static & Dynamic Reverse Engineering

GitHub: github.com/ConnarE92/Threat-Intel-and-Malware-Analysis

- Performed static analysis (dnSpy, PEStudio, Detect It Easy) of a live AgentTesla-family .NET sample in an isolated VM, identifying a custom XOR decryption routine and a reflective in-memory assembly-loading mechanism concealing the real payload.
- Conducted dynamic analysis (Process Monitor, RegShot, Wireshark, System Informer) confirming CLR-rooted thread behaviour consistent with the static findings, alongside RAS API interaction and periodic WMI-based polling.
- Cross-referenced static and dynamic evidence across three independent methods to validate persistence and network-activity conclusions, mapping all confirmed behaviour to MITRE ATT&CK (T1027, T1140, T1620, T1036).

Phishing Email & Attachment Analysis

GitHub: github.com/ConnarE92/Offensive-Security-and-eJPT-Prep/tree/main/Phishing-Analysis

- Analysed a real phishing email impersonating a cloud storage renewal notice, identifying urgency-based social engineering (threatened data deletion), a spoofed sender domain, and fraudulent branding designed to drive victims to an externally hosted credential/payment-harvesting page.
- Verified indicators using VirusTotal, urlscan.io, CyberChef, and MXToolbox to confirm sender-domain spoofing and malicious hosting infrastructure, mapping the attack to MITRE ATT&CK T1566.002, T1204.001, T1056.003, and T1036.005.
- Confirmed the email had been correctly intercepted by Gmail's native spam filtering prior to any user interaction, validating existing email security controls as part of the analysis.

HOME LAB & CONTINUOUS LEARNING

Ongoing home lab practice using VMware to build on the projects above through TryHackMe and Hack The Box, covering packet capture analysis and attacker-behaviour mapping to MITRE ATT&CK.

Defensive: Vulnerability assessment & management | Endpoint security & access control | Log correlation | Incident response workflows

Offensive (THM / HTB / eJPT prep): Reconnaissance & enumeration | Scanning & service identification | Privilege escalation | Lateral movement & pivoting | Password attacks & credential harvesting

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA Cybersecurity Analyst (CySA+) CS0-003 — 2026
- CompTIA A+ (220-1101 & 220-1102) — 2024
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (MS-900) — 2025
- Microsoft Certified: Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals (SC-900) — 2025
- Introduction to Ethical Hacking — Code Academy, 2023
- In Progress: eJPT — Sitting end of July 2026, hands-on offensive security certification (reconnaissance, enumeration, exploitation)

EDUCATION

- BA (Hons) Event & Sales Management, Teesside University, Middlesbrough, 2015
- NCFE Level 3 in Cyber Security Practices, Think Employment, 2023